GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

October 16th, 2026
Week 42
Volume 282, Issue 1257

Highlights:

- **Freight Retreats**
- **Hormuz Attacks**
- **Reserves Mobilised**
- **Bids Unchanged**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"Price is what you pay; value is what you get."

- Benjamin Graham

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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FREIGHT FINALLY FLINCHES

The dry freight retreat gathered pace this week, bringing awaited relief for recycling buyers without yet producing the ships they need. The Baltic Dry Index recorded a steep weekly fall, led by Capesizes, while recycling indications across all four destinations remained unchanged. Owners now face a less comfortable outlook for larger bulkers, but one week's correction cannot overturn months of profitable trading. Freight has blinked. The sellers have not.

The Strait of Hormuz supplied a troubling counterweight. Singapore-registered GFS Pride was struck on October 13 and subsequently sank after catching fire; GFS Giselle sustained hull damage in a separate incident the next day. All 43 crew members were reported safe. The attacks sharpened concerns over passage, security and insurance, keeping disruption in voyage calculations. For ageing tankers, altered routes and restricted effective availability can still make further employment more attractive than recycling.

Oil markets also absorbed an intervention. On October 15, the International Energy Agency announced plans to accelerate release of approximately 100 million barrels remaining under its March emergency stock programme, following around 330 million barrels already released. Brent nevertheless remained around USD 105 to 106 per barrel on Friday. Additional inventories may ease supply pressure, but cannot remove Gulf shipping risks. The cost of disruption survives the arrival of extra barrels.

Dry bulk was the more immediate source of encouragement for recyclers. The Baltic Dry Index fell from 2,973 on October 8 to 2,545 on Thursday, October 15, a decline of more than 14%. Capesizes dropped from 4,512 to 3,322, while Panamaxes eased to 2,356. Supramaxes moved against the trend, improving to 1,856. The uneven retreat matters: larger bulkers may be feeling pressure, but smaller and mid-sized ships continue to find worthwhile employment. Falling indices alone do not deliver vessels to the beaches.

Steel supplied no common regional signal. Bangladesh plate rose from BDT 64,000 to BDT 66,000 per ton despite subdued finished-steel demand. Indian plate finished at INR 42,300, below last Friday, although the stronger Rupee lifted its Dollar equivalent to USD 445.17. Pakistan eased to PKR 195,000, while Turkey faced weak domestic steel consumption and currency pressure. India's September inflation rose to 5.54%, complicating financing and demand. None of this altered the recycling price board.

Physical activity still exceeded fresh business. Alang delivered the 31,300 LDT LNG carrier Kano on October 15, reinforcing India's specialist position. Chattogram added several bulker and tanker arrivals, and Gadani delivered two previously secured bulkers. These movements represent ships already in the pipeline, not newly agreed sales. Bangladesh retains the conventional pricing lead, Pakistan remains competitive, India concentrates on specialist value, and Turkey holds its established regional position. No fresh market sales were reported this week.

The next test is whether dry freight declines for long enough to change owners' decisions. The correction is real, but tanker employment remains supported by Gulf disruption, while smaller dry sectors have surrendered little ground. Recycling buyers have maintained their numbers without securing a fresh supply of candidates. The market has started moving in their direction, although it has not arrived there yet. Owners will need more than one uncomfortable week before the beaches see the benefit.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 42 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

CHATTOGRAM NEEDS MORE THAN STEEL

Buyers Ready.

Chattogram remains at the top of the conventional recycling rankings, where buying appetite continues to exceed the supply of workable candidates. Recyclers are still prepared to compete for suitable bulkers, tankers and container units, but their leading position has not translated into a meaningful increase in new commitments. Freight earnings and second-hand alternatives still give owners reasons to keep trading. Conventional recycling indications remain unchanged across all vessel categories, maintaining Bangladesh's competitive advantage over neighbouring destinations. The demand exists; the opportunity to turn it into business remains scarce.

Plate Advance.

Local steel gave Chattogram a welcome lift, with plate rising from BDT 64,000 to BDT 66,000 per ton on October 11 and holding through Friday. Its Dollar equivalent increased from USD 522.24 to USD 538.56 per ton. The move improves the steel underpinning of vessel pricing, although demand for finished products remains subdued. At the waterfront, the 7,078 LDT bulker Uniorder arrived October 15 and the 8,275 LDT tanker Green October 14, following three smaller tankers earlier in the week. Petrova was delivered October 9, while the 911 LDT Pacific Leader is recorded as an arrival on October 6. These are movements of previously secured ships, not new recycling sales.

Seasonal Watch.

Attention is turning towards the approaching dry season, when construction activity and improved operating conditions may lift local steel demand. That improvement remains an expectation rather than an established trend. The upcoming Durga Puja banking closure from October 20 to 24, including weekly holidays, also makes advance coordination of documentation and settlement arrangements important ahead of the October 25 to 28 delivery tides. Limited banking services at port-related branches may continue during the holiday period. With domestic consumption still slow, stronger plate quotations alone may not support a higher bid. Chattogram has the leading conventional numbers and buyers to use them, but its next breakthrough depends on owners releasing suitable ships.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

ALANG LANDS ANOTHER GIANT

The delivery of the 31,300 LDT LNG carrier Kano on October 15 underlines a part of Alang's market that conventional rankings do not capture. Gas carriers, reefers, passenger ships and other non-ferrous-rich units can command markedly different economics from ordinary steel tonnage, allowing recyclers to pursue opportunities beyond the regional price contest. The 4,815 LDT Kadija also delivered on October 15, while Maymei, a 9,877 LDT tanker, was delivered October 11. These are movements of vessels committed earlier, but they sustain yard activity while the fresh sales list remains quiet.

Specialists Deliver.

Plate declined from INR 42,600 per ton last Friday to INR 42,300 on October 16, after briefly dipping to INR 41,800 midweek. In Dollar terms, however, the stronger Rupee lifted its equivalent from USD 435.23 at the start of the reporting period to USD 445.17 by Friday. The currency improvement provides support to recyclers, although it does not narrow the pricing differential with Bangladesh and Pakistan by itself. September inflation rose to 5.54%, while the recent increase in the policy repo rate to 5.50% adds financing and domestic demand considerations.

Currency Lifts.

The 8,767 LDT tanker Modeste arrived October 14, while the latest port position records the 9,886 LDT Enisey as delivered October 9. India's proposed inclusion of two facilities on the European List remains pending, but its compliance and specialist strengths continue to matter when owners assess recycling options. Conventional recycling indications remain unchanged, leaving India in third place behind Bangladesh and Pakistan. That ranking remains an honest description of Alang's position for standard tonnage. The specialist market continues to tell a different story.

Value Persists.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

GADANI'S PIPELINE COMES ASHORE

Pipeline Delivers.

Gadani's waterfront has continued to receive the benefit of vessels secured during its earlier buying run. Maestro, a 5,143 LDT bulker, was delivered on October 14, following the 7,381 LDT Portland 11 on October 9. These movements advance the existing pipeline rather than signal fresh transactions, and have helped satisfy some immediate yard requirements. Bangladesh remains ahead on conventional indications, but Pakistan retains competitive numbers and buyers willing to consider workable candidates. The more measured approach now reflects reduced urgency, not an absence of interest.

Steel Settles.

Steel began the week at PKR 192,000 per ton, or USD 691.39, before recovering to PKR 195,000, approximately USD 702.20, on October 12 and holding there through Friday. The increase reversed the early dip but left the market marginally below last week's closing PKR 196,000. With domestic finished-steel demand still cautious and imported scrap a competing source of supply, recyclers have limited incentive to chase vessel prices materially higher. The Rupee remains relatively stable and September inflation eased to 10.26%, providing some financial predictability without transforming the underlying demand picture.

Margins Matter.

Conventional recycling indications remain unchanged, with Pakistan retaining second place on the sub-continent rankings. The shortage of fresh recycling candidates continues to frustrate transactional activity, but buyers also have reason to be selective after receiving tonnage secured during the stronger August market. When owners bring appropriate units to market, Gadani should remain a credible competitor. For now, attention remains on margin discipline and downstream steel sales rather than indiscriminate competition. Ships are reaching the plots, even if the next wave of purchases is still waiting to be agreed.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

ALIAGA PICKS ITS MOMENT



Aliaga's recycling indications remain unchanged after the correction recorded last week, with domestic finished-steel demand and cautious mill purchasing still limiting appetite for higher-priced candidates. Local scrap economics have not provided an incentive for further upward movement, particularly in a market where imported scrap pricing and processing costs compete directly with vessel acquisition. Conventional indications consequently remain at last week's reduced levels. The board has settled for now, but the underlying steel market offers little urgency.

Prices Hold.

Turkey's September inflation slowed to 29.73%, a welcome improvement that has not removed pressure on purchasing power. The Turkish Lira remains weak against the Dollar, while the central bank's 37% policy rate continues to make working capital expensive. Such conditions encourage disciplined buying rather than speculation on a near-term recovery in steel consumption. For yards paying internationally for vessels and selling into a largely domestic scrap market, the currency and financing calculations remain demanding.

Currency Pressure.

Aliaga nonetheless retains a distinct commercial role through proximity to European owners, specialised vessel handling and relevant environmental requirements. These advantages can outweigh the substantial headline pricing gap with the sub-continent when vessel location and recycling compliance matter more than nominal price. The market remains selective, with no fresh sales reported this week, but its established niche continues to provide opportunities when appropriate tonnage becomes available.

Niche Endures.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly - Market Rankings

For Week 42 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	510 / LDT	530 / LDT	540 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	500 / LDT	520 / LDT	530 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	465 / LDT	485 / LDT	495 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	290 / LDT	300-310 / LDT	320 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- ***124.5 million barrels of oil*** *estimated to have been saved through ship recycling at Alang equal approximately* ***29 hours of global oil consumption.***

- ***72.55 million tonnes of CO2 emissions*** *estimated to have been avoided at Alang equal the annual emissions of approximately* ***15.8 million petrol-powered passenger cars.***

- ***276 million cubic yards of landfill space*** *estimated to have been saved through recycling at Alang could accommodate approximately* ***80 Great Pyramids of Giza*** *by volume.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
October 20 - Dussehra	October 25 – November 01 November 07 – November 14

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
20–24 October 2026 – Durga Puja	October 25 – October 28 November 07 – November 10

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
November 09 – Allama Iqbal Day	28–29 October 2026 – Republic Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of October 16, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Kadija	4,815	General Cargo	***Delivered October 15***
2	Kano	31,300	LNG Carrier	***Delivered October 15***
3	Modeste	8,767	Oil Tanker	Arrived October 14
4	Maymei	9,877	Oil Tanker	***Delivered October 11***
5	Enisey	9,886	Bulk Carrier	***Delivered October 09***

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of October 16, 2026

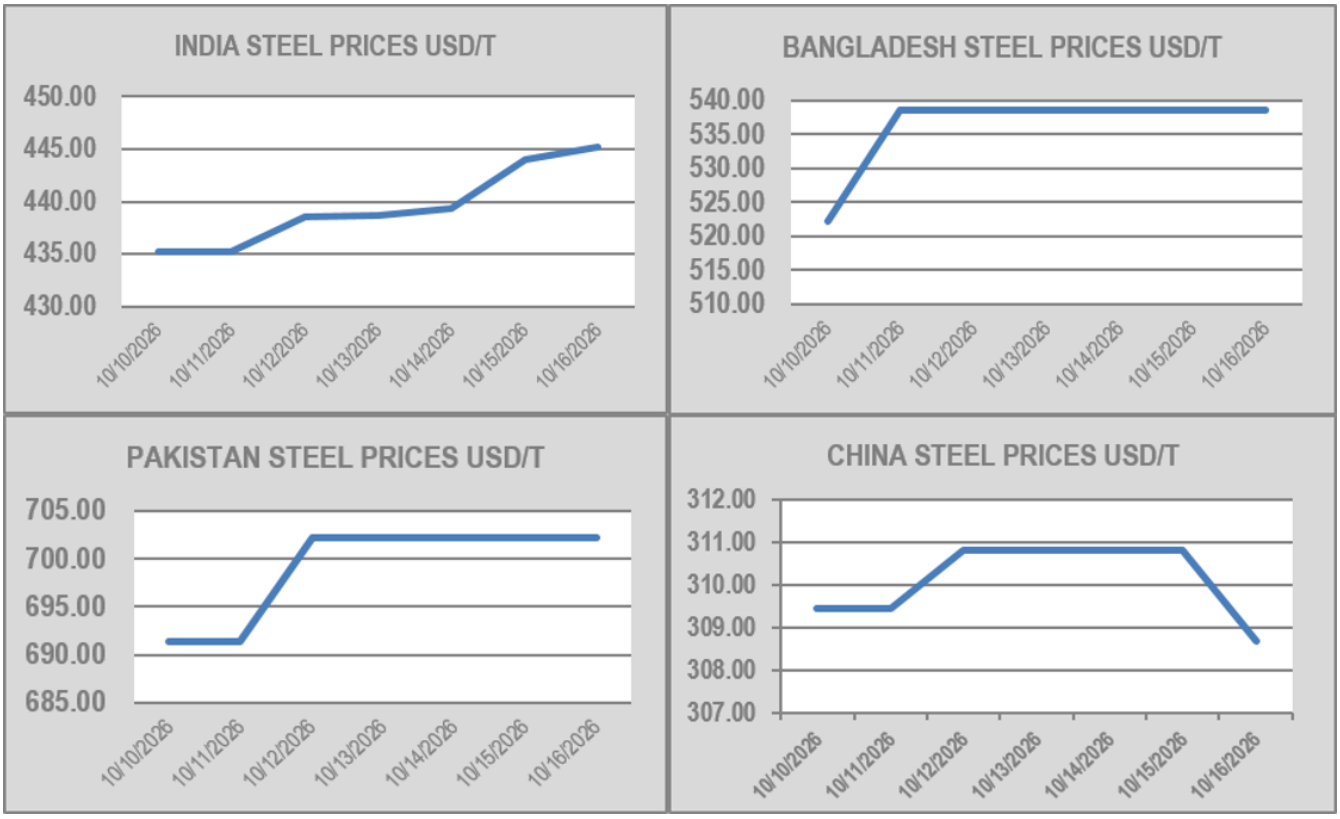
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Uniorder	7,078	Bulk Carrier	Arrived October 15
2	Green	8,275	Tanker	Arrived October 14
3	K.P.P. 02	1,288	Tanker	Arrived October 12
4	K.P.P. 03	1,336	Tanker	Arrived October 11
5	V. L. 15	1,427	Tanker	Arrived October 10
6	Petrova	2,398	Tanker	***Delivered October 09***
7	Pacific Leader	911	General Cargo	Arrived October 06
8	B-LPG Sophia (D/VSL)	3,421	LPG Tanker	Arrived September 28

GADANI - Port Position as of October 16, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Maestro	5,143	Bulk Carrier	***Delivered October 14***
2	Portland 11	7,381	Bulk Carrier	***Delivered October 09***

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DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
10/10/2026	435.23	42,100.00	691.39	192,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
10/11/2026	435.23	42,100.00	691.39	192,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	309.46
10/12/2026	438.50	42,000.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	310.84
10/13/2026	438.71	41,800.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	310.84
10/14/2026	439.31	41,800.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	310.84
10/15/2026	443.98	42,200.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	310.84
10/16/2026	445.17	42,300.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	308.69



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